

Organizational Behavior: Individual Dynamics in Organization

Module 2: Diversity and inclusion in organization

Lecture 1

Diverse workforce, inclusive mindset- 1



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Diversity defined

- Workforce diversity means similarities and differences among employees in terms of age, cultural background, physical abilities and disabilities, race, religion, gender, and sexual orientation (Saxena, 2014)
- Gender, culture, race, social and psychological characteristics are not the only way in which people are different, but also in their perspectives and prejudices. (As discussed in previous sessions)
- “Diversity makes the work force heterogeneous”

Reference: Saxena, A. (2014). Workforce Diversity: a key to improve productivity. *Procedia. Economics and Finance*, 11, 76–85.
[https://doi.org/10.1016/s2212-5671\(14\)00178-6](https://doi.org/10.1016/s2212-5671(14)00178-6)

Diversity in the workplace

Past view of diversity

- legal issue; that is, it has been directly against the law to discriminate against anyone, on any basis

Present view

- Now organizations are beginning to realize that diversity is not just something to deal with, but instead a reality to build on to make a stronger, more competitive enterprise.

“Diversity must be recognized and nurtured as the organization’s greatest asset, and the ability to attract and work with diverse talent must be seen as a critical competitive advantage”

Reference: Luthans, F., *Organizational behavior: An evidence-based approach twelfth edition*. IAP.

The head of the Society of Human Resource Management (SHRM) diversity initiatives has noted,

“Organizational diversity initiatives should not simply focus on getting people of color and women in the door, but embracing an inclusive culture to maintain these employees.”

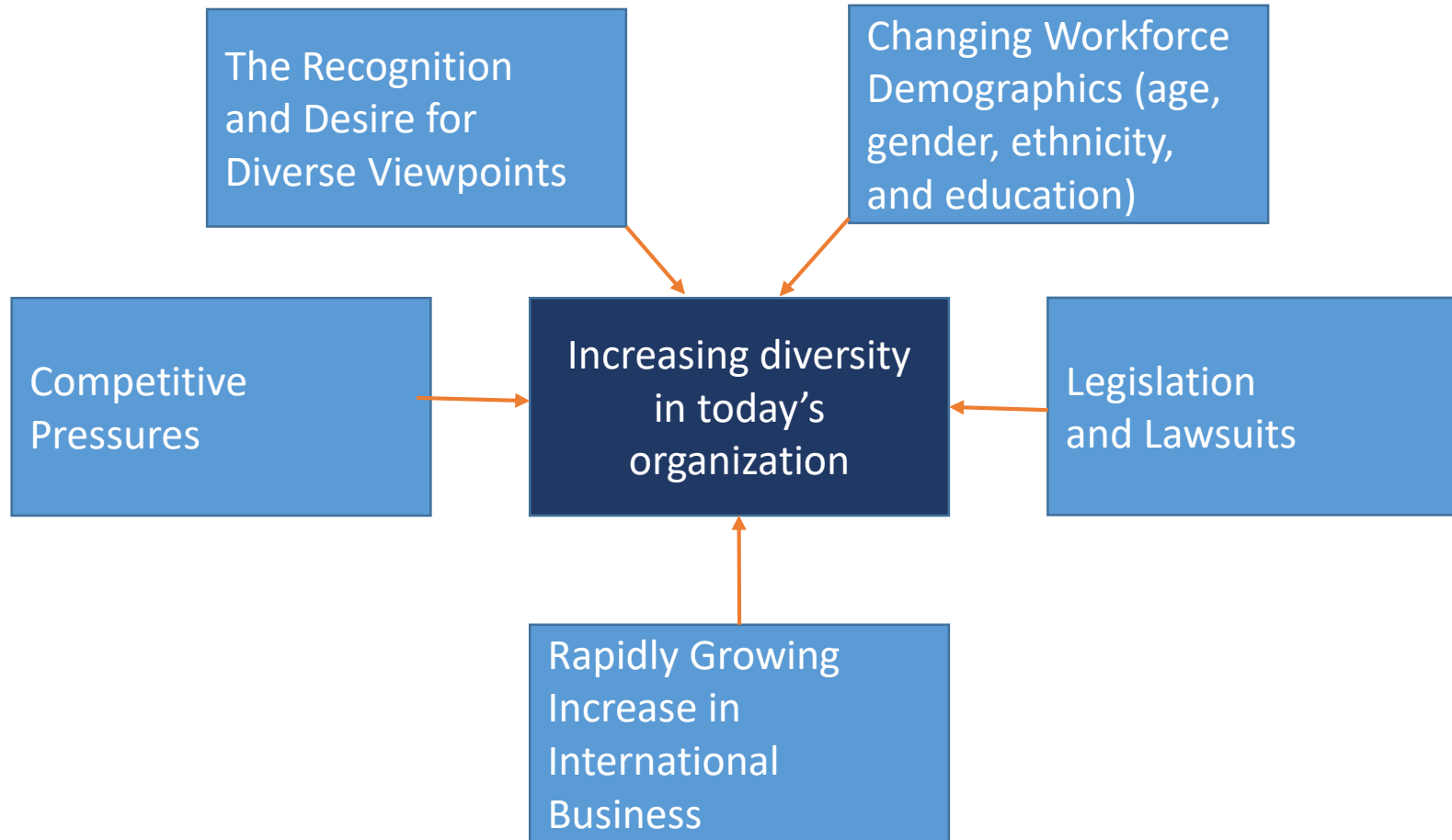
Effective diversity management

1. Creating a work environment or culture that allows everyone to contribute all that they can to the organization.

2. Leveraging differences and similarities in the workforce for the strategic advantage of the organization; and

3. Enhancing the ability of people from different backgrounds to work effectively together.

Major reasons for increasing diversity



Developing the Multicultural Organization

A multicultural organization has been described as one that:

- Reflects the contributions and interests of diverse cultural and social groups in its mission, operations, and product or service
- Acts on a commitment to eradicate social oppression in all forms within the organization
- Includes the members of diverse cultural and social groups as full participants, especially in decisions that shape the organization
- Follows through on broader external social responsibilities, including support of other institutional efforts to eliminate all forms of social oppression

Stages leading up to a multicultural organization



1. Exclusionary organization

2. Club organization

3. Compliance organization

4. Redefining organization

5. Multicultural organization

Individual Approaches to Managing Diversity

Learning

- Those who may not think they need to learn about diversity must work especially hard to learn an experience as much as they can about developing appropriate behavior
- At the heart of this learning process is communication

Empathy

- the ability to put oneself in another's place and see things from that person's point of view.
- members of diverse groups often feel that only they can truly understand the challenges or problems they are facing

Organizational Approaches to Managing Diversity

Testing

- Avoiding culturally biased selection and evaluation tests
- Using job-specific tests rather than general aptitude or knowledge tests

Training

- diverse group can be trained for an entry-level skill or how to more effectively do their existing or future job
- provide training to managers and other employees who work with diverse employees

Mentoring

- *mentor* is a trusted counselor, coach, or advisor who provides advice and assistance
- help support members of a diverse group in their jobs, socialize them in the cultural values of the organization, and pragmatically help their chances for development and advancement

Work/Family programs

- work-family issues have recently received considerable attention in research and practice
- alternative work schedule arrangements are flextime, the compressed workweek, job sharing, and telecommuting

Organizational Behavior: Individual Dynamics in Organization

Module 2: Diversity and inclusion in organization

Lecture 2

Diverse workforce, inclusive mindset- 2



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Is diversity enough?

- Take a moment to think of a workplace which has a diverse group of people working
- Do you feel this is where the duty of the organization stops?
- What would happen if there is no acceptance among different groups of people ?
- What should be the next step to ensure the full potential of the workforce is utilised?

The two types of diversity

Surface level diversity

- refers to the observable attributes and characteristics of individuals that are readily apparent, typically at first glance.
- **Race and Ethnicity, Gender, Age, Physical Abilities, Language, religion**
- they may not necessarily reflect the deeper aspects of an individual's identity, experiences, or perspectives.

Deep level diversity

- refers to the less visible, underlying differences among individuals that go beyond their surface-level characteristics
- **Values, attitudes, Experiences, Skills and knowledge, personality traits, cognitive styles**
- Deep-level diversity often has a more significant impact on how individuals interact and collaborate within a group or organization
- these differences can influence communication, decision-making, conflict resolution, and overall team dynamics

Diversity- *A double-edged sword*

- Owing to both its advantages and disadvantages, some scholars are of the view that diversity is a double-edged sword

Advantages

- Creativity
- innovation
- Better decisions
- Enhanced learning and growth

Disadvantages

- Inter-group conflicts
- Communication barriers
- Exclusion feeling by some groups
- More time to arrive at decisions

What is inclusion?

- Creating an environment where all individuals, regardless of their diverse characteristics, feel :
welcome, respected, valued, and included as full and equal members of the organization.
- fostering a culture that encourages
participation, collaboration, and a sense of belonging among all employees.
- Ensures that everyone's perspectives and contributions are acknowledged and leveraged to achieve organizational goals.

Inclusive leaders

- A Harvard Business Review article explains why inclusive leaders are good for organizations
- Inclusive leaders are individuals who “assures that all team members feel they are treated respectfully and fairly, are valued and sense that they belong, and are confident and inspired”
- Research done by two diversity experts, one human capital lead and a consultant as mentioned has revealed the following about inclusive leaders

**Harvard
Business
Review**

DIVERSITY

Why Inclusive Leaders Are Good for Organizations, and How to Become One

by Juliet Bourke and Andrea Espedido

MARCH 29, 2019

Steps that can make leaders more inclusive as given by the researchers:

**Visible
commitment**

Humility

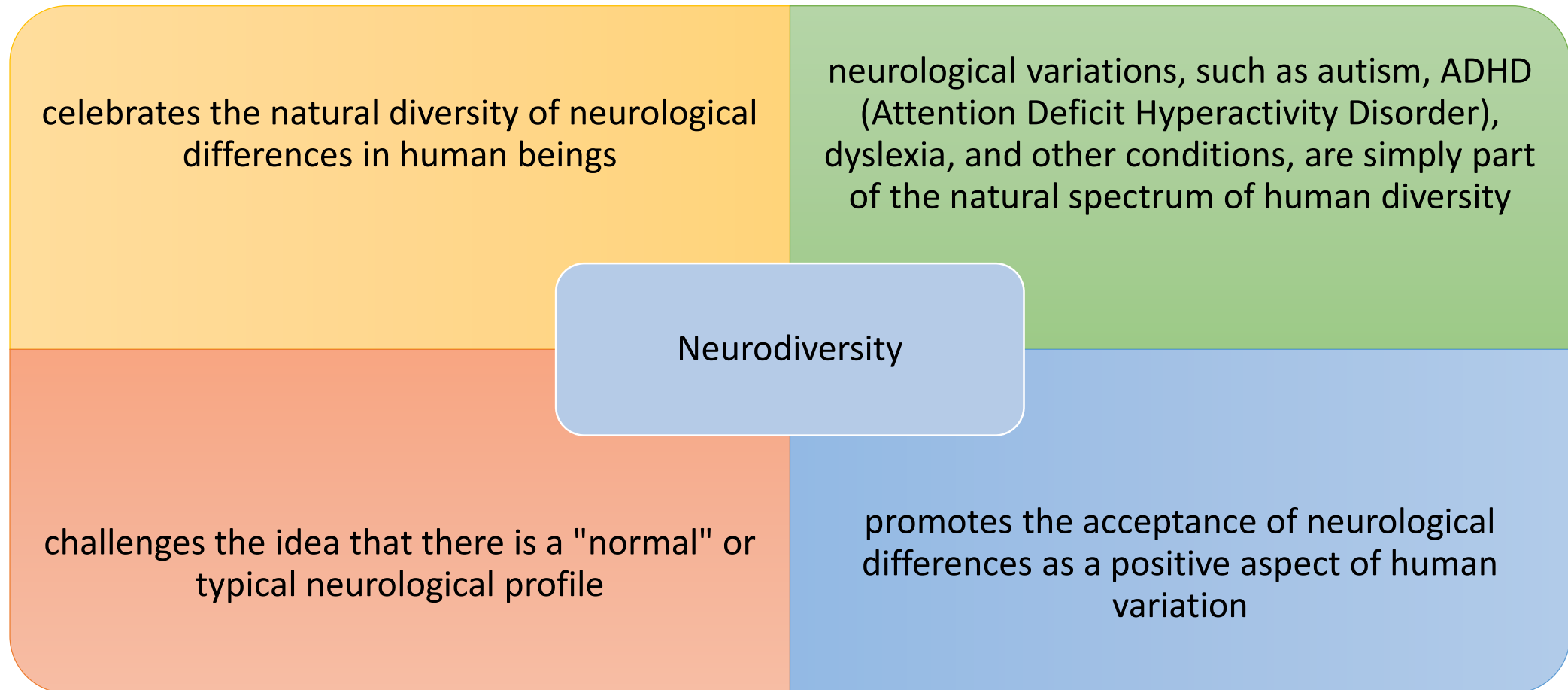
**Awareness
of bias**

**Curiosity
about others**

**Cultural
intelligence**

Addressing neurodiversity at workplace

Let's understand the term neurodiversity



Just like any form of diversity, employees with neurodivergence add to the organization in many ways:

- Diverse Perspectives and Problem-Solving
- Taking Inclusion and Equity forward
- Talent Pool Expansion
- Improved Team Dynamics
- Legal and Ethical Considerations
- Social responsibility

Diversity through data science at workplace:

Role of Individual

- Data science is an interdisciplinary field that combines techniques, processes, algorithms, and systems to extract insights and knowledge from structured and unstructured data.

❑ How is it used for understanding diversity at workplace?

- It is a powerful tool which allows organizations to collect, analyze, and interpret data related to employee demographics, behaviors, and experiences.
- Demographic analysis
- Hiring and recruitment
- Retention and attribution analysis
- Employee survey and sentiment analysis
- Performance and promotion analysis
- D&I program evaluation
- Benchmarking
- Recommendations for improvement

Individual level awareness and care in using Data Science for Diversity

Ethical Data Handling

- Privacy protection,
- informed consent

Bias Detection and Mitigation

- Bias awareness,
- bias mitigation

Transparency and Explainability

- Model interpretability,
- document processes

Engagement and Communication

- Stakeholder Engagement
- Effective Communication

Continuous Learning and Improvement

- **Stay Updated**
- Adapt and adjust

- Diversity by itself cannot ensure inclusion and equity

- Individual level belief, commitment in and awareness of inclusion is the way forward



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Lecture 3

Perception of diversity and inclusion



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Perceived diversity

- the degree to which people recognize that a group or area is made up of different social categories.
- It is a subjective assessment of the variety of backgrounds, experiences, and perspectives and knowledge level represented within the workforce.

Perceived diversity

- ❑ Why we need to know about perceived diversity when the effects of diversity is already known?
- Researchers who have studied both diversity and the perception of diversity have found out that :

“diversity perceptions are stronger predictors of diversity effects than actual diversity” (Harrison et., 2002; Kirchmeyer, 1995; Jaiswal, 2019)

Outcomes of perceived diversity

- In OB studies, direct relationships don't explain the whole scenario and hence focus is on the contextual variable which explains a phenomenon more accurately.
- Research in the Indian setting (Jaiswal et al., 2019) has revealed this outcome of perceived diversity:
- Perceived diversity leads to employee well-being when it is mediated by inclusion



Perceived Inclusion

- According to Guillaume et al., (2014),
“Perceived inclusion (PI) or inclusion beliefs deal with employees’ perception of being valued, respected, and empowered in a team”
- Mor barak, 2017 speaks of perceived inclusion as :
“derived from an individual’s sense of involvement in decision-making and their ability to access information from other group members”
- it reflects the degree to which an individual considers themselves a part of a group or critical organizational process (Ghosh, et al., 2020)

Fostering perceived inclusion

**Leadership and
Organizational
Culture**

**Diversity
Initiatives and
Policies**

**Communication
and Transparency**

**Social
Interactions and
Relationships**

**Career
Development and
Opportunities**

Diversity of Thought

❑ What is diversity of thought?

- the range of mindsets, thought processes, and perspectives that can be found within an organization's workforce
- idea of bringing together individuals from different cultures, backgrounds, and personalities to share their thoughts

Diversity of Thought

❑ Why is studying diversity of thought as a part of diversity initiatives debatable?

Demographic Diversity vs. Cognitive Diversity

Benefits of Cognitive Diversity

Potential Pitfalls

Balancing Act

Inclusivity and Respect

Measurement and Assessment

A Question of Discrimination

One of the first problems Jennifer faced at her father's Carter Cleaning Centers concerned the inadequacies of the firm's current HR management practices and procedures.

One problem that particularly concerned her was the lack of attention to equal employment matters. Each store manager independently handled virtually all hiring; the managers had received no training regarding such fundamental matters as the types of questions they should not ask of job applicants. It was therefore not unusual in fact, it was routine for female applicants to be asked questions such as Who's going to take care of your children while you are at work? And for minority applicants to be asked questions about arrest records and credit histories. Non-minority applicants three store managers were white males and three were white females were not asked these questions, as Jennifer discerned from her interviews with the managers. Based on discussions with her father, Jennifer deduced two reasons for the laid-back attitude toward equal employment: (1) her father's lack of sophistication regarding the legal requirements and (2) the fact that, as Jack Carter put it, "Virtually all our workers are women or minority members anyway, so no one can really come in here and accuse us of being discriminatory, can they?"

Jennifer decided to mull that question over, but before she could, she was faced with two serious equal rights problems. Two women in one of her stores privately confided to her that their manager was making unwelcome sexual advances toward them, and one claimed he had threatened to fire her unless she socialized with him after hours. And during a fact-finding trip to another store, an older gentleman he was 73 years old complained of the fact that although he had almost 50 years of experience in the business, he was being paid less than people half his age who were doing the very same job. Jennifer's review of the stores resulted in the following questions.

1. Is it true, as Jack Carter claims, that we can't be accused of being discriminatory because we hire mostly women and minorities anyway?
2. How should she and her company address the possible problems of age discrimination?



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Lecture 4 **Ableism and Inclusion**



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Defining ableism

- Ableism in the workplace refers to discrimination, prejudice, or bias against individuals with disabilities.
- Unfair treatment with persons with disability intentionally or unintentionally.
- Creates barriers that prevent individuals with disabilities from fully participating in and benefiting from the workplace.

Models of disability

- The three overarching models of disability are (Olkin, 2002)



1

**Moral
model**

As a mark of wrongdoing or
as a sign of honor, faith or
strength

2

**Medical
model**

An impairment in a
body system or function
that is inherently
pathological



3

**Social
model**

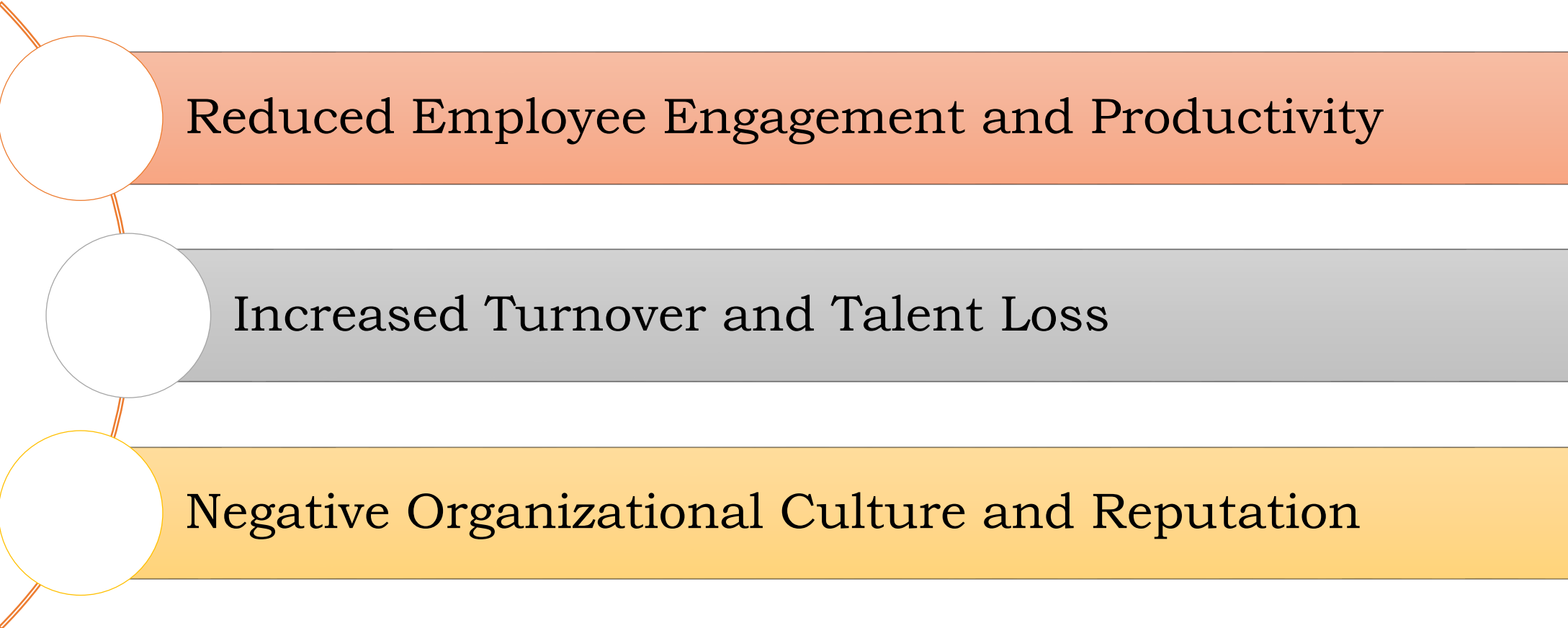
Result from a mismatch between the
disabled person and the environment
(both physical and social)

The social model as a basis for understanding ableism in organizations

- The social model explains disability in terms of barriers (French & Swain, 2011):

Structural barriers	Environmental barriers	Attitudinal barriers
• Underlying norms, mores and ideologies of organisations and institutions • Based on judgements of 'normality' • Sustained by hierarchies of power	• Physical barriers within the environment, for example steps, holes in the pavement and lack of resources for disabled people • The ways things are done, which may exclude disabled people • Example: the way meetings are conducted and the time allowed for tasks	• The adverse attitudes and behavior of people towards persons with disability

How does ableism affect organizations?



Reduced Employee Engagement and Productivity

Increased Turnover and Talent Loss

Negative Organizational Culture and Reputation

Diversity, equity and inclusion

- What is equity? Are equity and equality the same?



Diversity, equity and inclusion

Equality

Everyone receives the same resources or opportunities regardless of their individual needs or circumstances

Treating all employees, regardless of their background or characteristics, with the same policies, benefits, and opportunities.

Equity

Resources or opportunities are distributed according to individual needs to ensure that everyone has an equal chance to participate and access the benefits

Accessible workspaces and assistive technologies

Case study

Founded in 1966 and headquartered in Richfield, MN, Best Buy's company's mission is to be a "growth company focused on better solving the unmet needs of our customers — and we rely on our employees to solve those puzzles."

- The company started as a stand-alone Sound of Music (now known as Best Buy) store in Roseville, MN and has grown to nearly 1,200 stores in the U.S. and globally and several subsidiary brands. Best Buy attracts employees and customers of all types and from very diverse backgrounds. One of its leading company goals is to make Best Buy “a great place to work by having fun while being the best.” The company's diversity, equity, inclusion and accessibility (DEIA) efforts are a cornerstone of the company's commitment to creating a more inclusive future, both inside the company and in the communities where Best Buy operates.

Case study

- Individuals on the autism spectrum may find it challenging to get hired and also retain jobs due to social differences or other factors. After hearing from multiple retail employees that training was needed to ensure Best Buy employees with autism felt fully included, the company's management contacted members of its autism-focused affinity group, FACE (Facing Autism in a Caring Environment), for assistance. In January 2011, FACE partnered with the Autism Society of Minnesota and members of Best Buy's corporate training team to develop a comprehensive eLearning course to educate employees on ways to ensure autistic employees and customers feel welcomed and included.
- Both Best Buy retail and corporate staff served on the eLearning development team, including cashiers, finance team members and services agents. The co-chair of Best Buy's disability affinity group, INCLUDE, and two eLearning developers also served on the team. The team developed an eLearning software application at a cost of approximately \$10,000.

Case study

- Best Buy management felt this initiative yielded a tremendous return on investment. The majority of employees who completed the eLearning module commented that they now “get it” and have learned to recognize certain behaviors that coworkers or customers may exhibit as part of being on the autism spectrum and work with them more effectively. It is also one of the highest-rated eLearning courses among the thousands offered through Best Buy’s Learning Lounge program.
- As a result of this success, Best Buy packaged the eLearning module and made it customizable, and it is now available through the Autism Society of Minnesota to any organization who is interested in using it. For Best Buy, the lesson learned is that when you educate and create awareness, you dispel myths and therefore lessen fears and stigma.



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Module 2: Diversity and inclusion in organization

Lecture 5

Diversity management



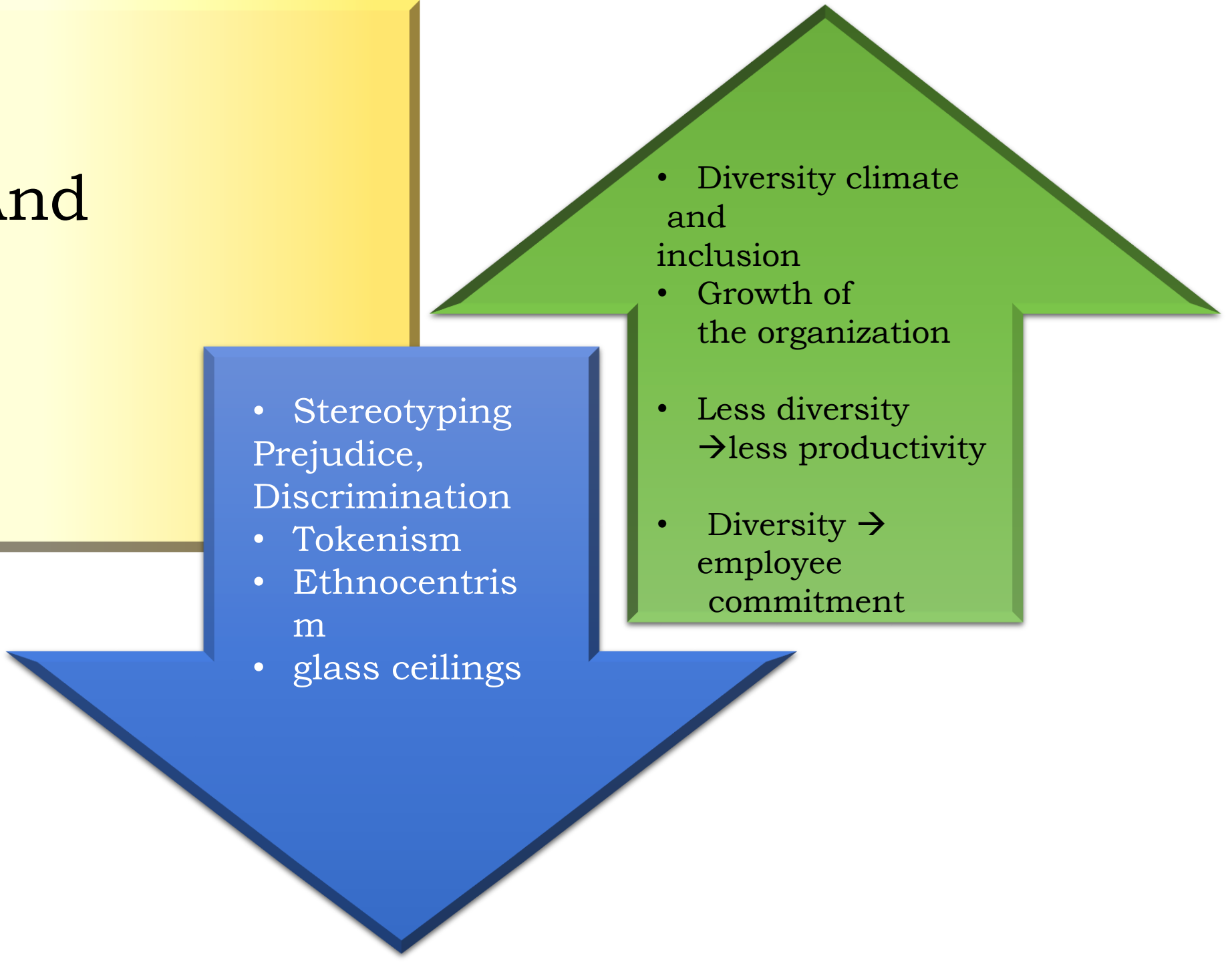
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Diversity's Downsides And Benefits

- 
- Stereotyping
Prejudice,
Discrimination
 - Tokenism
 - Ethnocentris
m
 - glass ceilings

- Diversity climate
and
inclusion
- Growth of
the organization
- Less diversity
→ less productivity
- Diversity →
employee
commitment

Compulsory
actions
Policy compliance
And guidelines

Voluntary actions
Encouraging
employees to
work together

Managing diversity

Maximizing diversity's
advantages and
minimizing barriers

Top-down Programs

Provide strong leadership
Assess the situation
Provide diversity training and
education
Change culture and
management systems
Evaluate the diversity
management program

AGEM Diversity
training process

Approach

Goals

Executive commitment,
Mandatory attendance

Encouraging Inclusiveness

Inclusive strategies

Personal Level

- Become aware of prejudice and other barriers to valuing diversity
- Learn about other cultures and groups
- Serve as an example, walk the talk
- Participate in managing diversity

Interpersonal level

- Facilitate communication and interactions in ways that value diversity
- Encourage participation
- Share your perspective
- Facilitate unique contributions
- Resolve conflicts in ways that value diversity
- Accept responsibility for developing common ground

Organizational Level

- All employees have access to networks and focus groups
- All employees take a proactive role in managing diversity and creating a more diverse workplace culture
- All employees are included in the inner circle that contributes to the bottom-line success of the company
- All employees give feedback to teams and management
- All employees are encouraged to contribute to change

Barriers to inclusion

- Stereotypes, prejudices
- Past experiences and influences
- Stereotyped expectations and perceptions

- Cultural differences
- Group differences
- Myths
- Relationship patterns based on exclusion

- Checking on Individuals who get away with discriminating and excluding
- A culture that values or allows exclusion
- Work structures, policies, and practices that discriminate and exclude

Take an active role in
educating yourself.

Realize that you
are not alone

Put yourself in a
learning mode in any
multicultural setting

Developing A
Multicultural
Consciousness

Don't be too hard on yourself if
misunderstandings arise

Move beyond
your personal
comfort zone



Affirmative Action Program

Affirmative action means making an extra effort to hire and promote those in protected groups, particularly when those groups are underrepresented.

Implementing Affirmative action program

Aims:

- (1) to use numerical analysis to determine which (if any) target groups the firm is underutilizing relative to the relevant labor market, and
- (2) to eliminate the barriers to equal employment.

Steps:

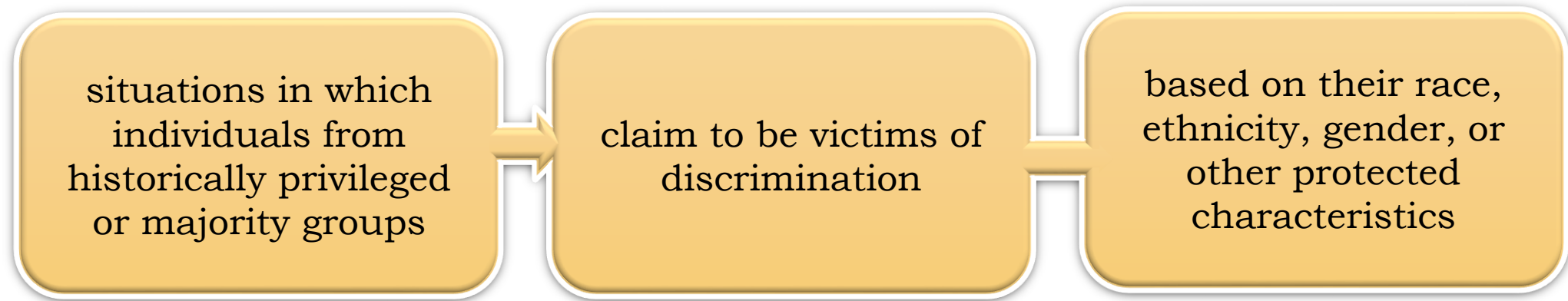
Recruiting
Minorities
Online

Employee
Resistance

Program
Evaluation

Addressing Reverse Discrimination

- Reverse discrimination refers to:



-
- In essence, it is the assertion that affirmative action or other efforts to address historical discrimination against marginalized groups have resulted in unfair treatment or disadvantages for individuals from non-marginalized or majority groups.

Managing Diversity for Success: The Case of IBM

- IBM has always been a leader in diversity management. Yet, the way diversity was managed was primarily to ignore differences and provide equal employment opportunities. This changed when Louis Gerstner became CEO in 1993.
- Gerstner was surprised at the low level of diversity in the senior ranks of the company. For all the effort being made to promote diversity, the company still had what he perceived a masculine culture.

Managing Diversity for Success: The Case of IBM

In 1995, he created eight diversity task forces around demographic groups such as women and men, as well as Asians, African Americans, LGBT (lesbian, gay, bisexual, and transgender) individuals, Hispanics, Native Americans, and employees with disabilities. These task forces consisted of senior-level, well-respected executives and higher-level managers, and members were charged with gaining an understanding of how to make each constituency feel more welcome and at home at IBM. Each task force conducted a series of meetings and surveyed thousands of employees to arrive at the key factors concerning each particular group. For example, the presence of a male-dominated culture, lack of networking opportunities, and work-life management challenges topped the list of concerns for women. Asian employees were most concerned about stereotyping, lack of networking, and limited employment development plans. African American employee concerns included retention, lack of networking, and limited training opportunities. Armed with a list of priorities, the company launched a number of key programs and initiatives to address these issues. As an example, employees looking for a mentor could use the company's Web site to locate one willing to provide guidance and advice. What is probably most unique about this approach is that the company acted on each concern whether it was based on reality or perception. They realized that some women were concerned that they would have to give up leading a balanced life if they wanted to be promoted to higher management, whereas 70% of the women in higher levels actually had children, indicating that perceptual barriers can also act as a barrier to employee aspirations. IBM management chose to deal with this particular issue by communicating better with employees as well as through enhancing their networking program.

Managing Diversity for Success: The Case of IBM

What was the result of all these programs?

IBM tracks results through global surveys around the world and identifies which programs have been successful and which issues no longer are viewed as problems. These programs were instrumental in more than tripling the number of female executives worldwide as well as doubling the number of minority executives. The number of LGBT executives increased sevenfold, and executives with disabilities tripled. With growing emerging markets and women and minorities representing a \$1.3 trillion market, IBM's culture of respecting and appreciating diversity is likely to be a source of competitive advantage.



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